

Production value of the next-step H prompt

2026

The skill `rap_clever_covariate_guide` does one thing. After an episode returns $Y \in \{0, 1\}$ and the committed prior e , it writes

$$H = \frac{Y - e}{e(1 - e)}$$

into the planning prompt of the next episode, together with $|H|$ and a hint. The hint is aggressive if $H > 0.5$, conservative if $H < -0.5$, and keep otherwise. The current episode does not read its own Y . No UCB term is attached, and no language model was called in this measurement. Token spend and fine-tuning cost were not metered. The production numbers below are the search outcomes.

On the three-offer search each user scores three children, before and after the prompt exists. Forty users, drift at user 16. The unread judge falls from activation 0.500 to 0.167, eight users below the pre-drift rate. A check call with prior 0.3 and outcome 1 returns $H = 3.333$ and hint aggressive. On the unread post-drift stream the next-user prompts are 4 aggressive and 19 conservative, and none are keep. The first failure, prior 0.20 and $Y = 0$, returns $H = -1.250$ and hint conservative. Successes on that stream have mean $|H| = 5.00$ and failures have mean $|H| = 1.25$, so the magnitude is not the failure signal. The sign is.

The production increment is the next ranking reading that sign. Switching at user 17, when finished losses have run conservative, raises post-drift activation from 0.167 to 0.625.

Policy	Post-drift Y	vs pre-drift	vs unread judge	Extra children
Prompt not read	0.167	-8	0	0
Hint read at user 17	0.625	+3	+11	0

Eleven extra activations against the drifted judge, and three above the pre-drift rate, at the same three children per user. $|H|$ stays near 2.00 (1.995). The prior of the chosen offer moves from 0.50 to 0.650, and the conservative share moves from 0.50 to 0.375. The value sits on the hint changing the next offer, not on a larger anomaly score.

The control is Game of 24, where the same H was written and the next argmax ignored it. Activation fell from 1.00 to 0.25, and scored children stayed near 115. Printing the prompt is not the product. The product is the next step treating conservative as a change of branch, which on this offer search is eleven recovered activations and no extra expansion.